

Dynasty Chronicle

From the Desk of the Commissioner
Wednesday, September 9th, 2026

"Price is what you pay, value is what you get." – Warren Buffett

FADE IN

EXTERIOR - FALLBROOK, CALIFORNIA - AFTERNOON

It is a hot and stormy day on a golf course. The camera pans across a wide expanse of grass toward a path on which two golf carts are driving toward camera. As camera approaches, the golf carts stop at a tee box. Raucous conversation can be heard but not interpreted. One of the men repeatedly makes a sound impersonating a pterodactyl or vulture. As camera approaches, pterodactyl man jovially jumps out of the cart and approaches the tee box without waiting for the others. He drops a fluorescent golf ball on the grass and begins to line up for a shot. The camera pans back toward his companions, who appear to be caught up in selecting clubs and discussing their shots. Camera pans back to tee box where pterodactyl man is no longer alone but is standing next to an ominous figure. It is immediately understood that this figure is an apparition or hallucination with some connection to the pterodactyl man. The man notices the spirit out of the corner of his eye but seems to want to avoid an encounter. The spirit glides slightly closer to the man and begins to speak.

SPIRIT

Your poor etiquette comes as no surprise to me.

MAN

Just leave me be. I told you already, I will do what is necessary tonight
for our plan to work.

SPIRIT

Are you not concerned about your comrades? I hear murmurs of a bidding
war brewing under your nose, yet you seem to concern yourself only with
Sun Cruisers. Should the ritual not be completed as intended--

MAN (interrupting)

Save the blabbering about the ritual. The "bidding war" you're hearing
about is just Cal's feeble attempt to get under my skin. Bowers will be
ours, drop it.

SPIRIT

The curse that should fall upon you will be immense. You'll be fated to
err.

MAN (annoyed)

I'm not worried about anything. What's the worst that could happen?

SPIRIT

Jameson Williams...

MAN (indifferent)

Again, not a problem. Just let me take my shot before the guys see.

SPIRIT

For twenty-six dollars...

The man stiffens. His group, now standing nearby notices his change in body language.

MAN #2 (concerned)

Marcus, you good? Let's get the shot off. Two-some behind us is putting.

SPIRIT (satisfied)

Do I have your attention?

MAN (to Spirit, frustrated)

There is not a world in which I would stray so carelessly from my plan as to do something like that.

SPIRIT (with sinister snark)

But you're a "bad drafter". Everyone knows it. Surely you can use your poorly manufactured reputation as a veil to hide behind.

MAN (frustrated)

I will bid whatever is necessary to get Bowers and complete the ritual, happy?

SPIRIT (melancholy)

I have been doomed by Berrion never to approach the foothills of happiness again. It is a bitter pain that you'd even suggest such an impossibility in the company of your friends. How I long for friendship...

The man eases his posture and looks at the Spirit. His countenance changes. He takes a step toward the spirit and extends his arms.

MAN (tenderly)

Come here.

The ghost expresses disgust, regret, and deep sadness. He hesitantly reaches out to accept the man's embrace.

SPIRIT (on the verge of tears)

In the shallow depths of my soul-less form, I long to have what you and Noah have. Cherish him.

Camera looks on from behind the man's group and reveals him hugging an empty space at the edge of the tee box. They look curiously on but refrain from speaking. It is evident to them that, somehow, something of importance is happening. They remain silent.

Behind the group, another golf cart pulls up. An apparent stranger is driving it and takes in the scene. He is clearly confused and angry. He takes a step out of the cart.

STRANGER (with rage)

Would you hit the damn ball?

Camera focuses back on the man embracing the Spirit. He takes a step back toward his golf ball and proceeds to set up for a shot. Without even the slightest hesitation of preparedness, he swings harder than conceivably possible. The ball torpedoes to the left with intense speed, striking a duck swimming in the pond past the front of the tee box. To everyone's surprise, the duck utters a strangely human-like moan before it sinks.

END SCENE

The Price of Potential, The Value of Success

The 2026 season is officially set to commence as the league has completed its second auction. A long, hot, summer night invited the ED members to the residence of Jordan Menard to place their bids on their favorite players and begin another conquest to hoist the—whatever it is that the winner gets. Menard's gracious hosting capping the offseason could aptly be compared to a murderous scumbag donating his fortune to an orphanage with his dying breath to avoid 500 years in purgatory but was nonetheless warmly accepted by the league—although noticeably missing from said hot summer night was a decent hydration option for the parched league members.

In a stunning twist of fate, all ten league members were physically present for the draft; something that has often been referred to as the “fifty-year storm” of ED occurrences. Jordan, the aforementioned benevolent host, did his best Boomer impression by buying dinner for a bunch of ingrateful kids, playing nothing but classic rock, and constantly reminding said kids that “they don't make music like this anymore”. Kyle O'Keefe, extending an olive branch to airport employees around the world, successfully made the pilgrimage to the West Coast with the apparent directive from Jordan's wife to eliminate the beer supply because she doesn't want to see Jordan get “tubby” again. Mason Burns, donning his new “hey, it can't hurt to be fifteen minutes early to my mid-life crisis” Raiders hat, was able to show up after giving everyone in his house a Benadryl. Isaac Williams was somehow able to peel his eyes away from watching the Angels disgrace the tradition of baseball and make the strenuous journey to Jordan's not just to draft his team but mostly in hopes of “strengthening the long-held tradition of community” in Buena Creek. Marcus Rethwisch exhausted the remainder of his marital PTO for the 2020's to be in attendance. Cal Roberts, riding a high that he can sadly only experience now through beating someone in golf, was able to attend partly due to telling his wife and family that he was in Phoenix for a work conference (the Roberts family is very excited for his “early” return on Friday). Cody Scheiwe, though very regretful over the opportunity cost of getting to spend a much-needed afternoon and evening building an outdoor shower for dogs in his side yard, made sure to be there to, at the very least, mansplain the structural benefits of a crawlspace to Jordan. Noah May was a shoe-in to attend mostly because he experiences an out-of-body euphoric seizure whenever he steps foot on a property he played a part in buying or selling. Carter Roberts got permission to attend by promising his wife that he'd spend the subsequent three days alone in the Mojave Desert on a strict diet of beetles and moths in order to purge himself of the EMF radiation he'd be exposed to at Jordan's. And lastly, Drew Gilmore, the Captain Ahab of the enterprise was there to continue the search for his white whale: a fantasy season where everyone is content—safe to say the Pequod has many nautical miles ahead of it still.

One of the biggest questions going into the draft was how prior-ownership bias would factor into the price tags of some of the top free agents. The answer to that arrived faster than the delivery of a baby born to a woman whose husband has a golf event scheduled near her due date. Cal Roberts made a statement with his nomination of Brock Bowers, one of reigning-champion Marcus Rethwisch's prized targets. League members noticed a concrete shift in Rethwisch's demeanor once Bowers was won by Roberts, which makes sense because Marcus loves concrete. After that, all bets were off. Players who were anticipated to sell for chump change sold for small fortunes, and other noteworthy players fell through the cracks to patient bidders late. When all was said and done, league managers experienced a sweeping array of emotions from puzzlement to elation. Here were our consensus best and worst picks for each team:

San Marcos Emperors

Best: Jalen Hurts for \$64

Burns has been rumored to secretly adore light-skinned quarterbacks, so this one didn't surprise anybody. The price may age poorly, but the production will numb the pain.

Worst: Jacory Croskey-Merritt for \$27

I thought Trump was supposed to solve inflation, but I've been wrong at least once. Burns is now doomed to a fate few can bear: having to care about Washington football games.

South California Blackskins

Best: Tucker Kraft for \$12

Kraft may or may not come from a rich lineage of cheese magnates, and that's a *really* good thing when you remember he plays for the Packers. Plus, his torn ACL was replaced with a huge rubber band that should hold long enough to get Rethwisch a good chunk of points.

Worst: Kyler Murray for \$24

Rethwisch had one job to do in this draft: get a cheap-as-hell backup QB. Whoops! Luckily, this varietal pairs nicely with the \$65 Justin Jefferson cabernet.

San Diego Orcas

Best: Christian Watson for \$5

This pick made Menard look like a savvy drafter stashing some upside for cheap, but his true motivation eludes us. This pick could be likened to a tower of rats in a trench coat sitting in the back row of a Tony Robbins event. Sure, they'll blend into the crowd, but will they truly *learn* anything?

Worst: Kyren Williams for \$52

The SEC investigation into price-gouging is still open, so we'll keep our comments vague. This pick was likely the product of Menard's checking of Super Bowl odds five minutes before the draft and the ensuing triggering of seeing the Rams logo pop up on the screen.

Vallecitos Snowmen

Best: Brock Bowers for \$46

Considering the winning bids that would follow, \$46 seems to actually have been a decent value on a guy who could go nuclear (so long as he doesn't decide to randomly surgically tinker with his meniscus). The implications were also too tasty to pass up. Roberts snatching Bowers from the grips of Rethwisch resembles an alternate universe in which Rethwisch embodies Hollywood darling Liam Neeson in Pierre Morel's 2008 megahit "Taken"—but in this version, the Albanian kidnappers never get caught.

Worst: Patrick Mahomes for \$37

Sure, you could argue the QB market in this draft was all over the place and Roberts landed a nice little fella who's good at football, but we as an editorial staff just don't really like Patrick Mahomes as a person or player so this one stinks.

Escondido Covenant

Best: Trevor Lawrence for \$61

Yes, the price was steep, but Gilmore has had a QB-sized hole in his heart since he traded away Josh Allen last offseason, and this was the first step on a long road to heal.

Worst: Tetairoa McMillan for \$33

Gilmore tried to get gimmicky and run up the price on Scheiwe and it was going great until Scheiwe froze harder than Mason in a black church at \$33.

Carlsbad Cucks

Best: Jaxson Dart for \$45

Dart is who May pictures as himself when he basks in his memories of high school. There couldn't have been a better owner-player fit here. This rounded out perhaps the ziest QB room in the ED.

Worst: Zach Wilson for \$3

Can you put a price on an incredibly average bit? Yes; that price is \$3.

Beuna Creek Banshees

Best: Jaylen Waddle for \$23

Williams is an intangibles guy. He's also a guy who resonates deeply with athletes riddled with injury. These two were made for each other. That said, Bo Nix will probably throw to Waddle a lot and the Banshees will be better for it.

Worst: Travis Hunter for \$1

Williams may as well have drafted Myles Garrett. Hunter is destined to be a rusted-out Volvo burning a hole in the front yard of the waiver wire.

Moonlight Indians

Best: Carnell Tate for \$9

Exciting rookie from Ohio State? Say no more. This was a ball-knowers-know type pick and Roberts has plenty of margin to work with considering the strength he was building on at WR.

Worst: Rashee Rice for \$37

Rice went to jail. What's next: drafting Sam Bankman-Fried? Bad guys go to jail and we don't like bad guys.

Cap City Jedi

Best: Bo Nix for \$26

We really don't want to over-glaze Kyle for this, but it was a great pick (albeit partially caused by everyone bidding like sissies on QB's early). Kudos to O'Keefe for tuning out the noise.

Worst: Marshawn Lloyd for \$18

It's one thing to get a handcuff for your naughty RB1, but for 9% of your budget? Call an ambulance, because Dave Ramsey just went into cardiac arrest.

Rancho Vista Ponies

Best: Joe Burrow for \$70

To the rest of us who faltered during Burrow's bidding: shame on us. Burrow will no doubt make a big difference for the Ponies, and no one will remember or care how much he cost. Scheiwe saw the value and acted accordingly.

Worst: Travis Kelce for \$1

I know Scheiwe is a Swiftie, but was this really necessary? Is it not enough to just listen to that podcast Kelce does and scroll the tabloid pictures after you put the kids to bed? Let's call this what it is: a parasocial relationship on the brink of becoming dangerous.

The ED Goes Golfing: A Delightfully Positive Afternoon

Believe it or not, the ED showed up in a big (70%) way for their first annual golf event. The boys had an electric afternoon at the links and the energy was undeniable. The group got its first taste of the newly drawn line in the sand separating the Leucadia and Cardiff divisions. Cody Scheiwe fired off what will long be regarded as "the shot heard around the world": a fluorescent red ball nuked into the deep brush, and the boys were off.

Team Leucadia took a "strictly business" approach, meaning they just let Cal do his thing and stayed out of his damn way. However, every Wayne Gretzky needs his Mark Messier. Cal's teammates stepped up in big moments; Cody and Kyle both drained eagle putts that proved crucial when the scorecards were tallied. The team stayed cool when it counted; each birdie was capped with a mellow handshake and a sober nod of the head shared amongst the group as if to collectively say "we're not finished yet" or "on to Cincinnati" or "it's not enough". The focus, like a carbon deposit deep in the earth, hardened into a diamond.

Team Cardiff took a different approach altogether. Their banter and energy, while attractive from a distance, screamed "like and subscribe". Carter Roberts, as predicted by this very publication, had his work cut out for him in leading this squad. Luckily for Roberts, his cast and crew came ready to hit the shots. Noah May played lights-out golf despite nearly having his leg divided by two in a golf cart maneuver you'd expect to see in a M.A.D.D. film. Marcus Rethwisch wielded his 20lb "look at me, I promise I'm fun" Chinese putter to roll the rock straight and true. The sadly missed presence of Isaac Williams and Mason Burns transubstantiated into the flesh-and-blood form of Josh Dyer, who played his part well in keeping the team's score in the red.

At the end of it all, Team Leucadia prevailed by 2 strokes; a margin so small that a rematch surely lurks in the not-so-distant future.